

WGS AIMS FOR SUSTAINABLE PROSPERITY & PROGRESSIVE FUTURE

► The 13th edition of the World Governments Summit (WGS), held in Dubai from February 3 to 5, 2026, attracted the highest level of leadership participation in the event's history. More than 60 heads of states and governments, over 500 ministers, and representatives from more than 150 countries attended in the summit, which the UAE leadership said advanced its vision of empowering governments to drive change, create opportunities, and enhance readiness to navigate rapidly evolving global challenges.

Mohammad Al Gergawi, Minister of Cabinet Affairs and Chairman of the WGS, said that the attempt of the summit was to achieve sustainable prosperity and ensure a stable and progressive future for societies worldwide.

He noted that outcomes of previous editions have significantly shaped sustainable development strategies around the world and added that, amid accelerating global transformations, the summit has become a key platform for international dialogue, creative thinking, and innovative solutions that support long-term stability, prosperity, and human progress.

As part of efforts to advance government knowledge, the summit released 36 strategic reports in collaboration with global think tanks and academic institutions and conducted the third Global Ministers Survey to identify development priorities and support more effective policymaking.

The next edition of the WGS will take place from February 1 to 3, 2027.



Daniel Grieder, Chief Executive Officer, Hugo Boss



Fleur Pellerin, businesswoman and former Minister of Culture, France

it was whether journalism would survive the transformation intact.

India Today Group Vice Chairperson and Managing Director Kalli Purie offered a framework she called the “AI sandwich”: “You have human intent at the beginning, AI in the middle to help you augment, and then you have the

human decision at the end.”

But she also raised a chilling generational question, “What if AI natives don’t see trust the same way as we do? What if a bit of lying and hallucination is okay by them? That raises very big existential questions for us on credibility.”

India Today Group Chairman Aroon Purie was unequivocal about where the line must be drawn.

“AI is just an engine. But the driver is a human, and also has the brakes,” he said. “In this world of abundant information, interpretation, meaning, and ethics is what humans have to bring to the table.”

FROM TOOLS TO INTENT

Elsewhere, the tension between automation and authenticity played out in consumer technology. Nothing CEO Carl Pei described a future where “everybody will have their own personalised operating system, because we’re all different.”

The shift, Pei suggested, is from asking machines to act to machines anticipating intent.